*Press Release*

*Unthought: Somewhere and Elsewhere,*

*Featuring artist solo show:*
*Reid Surmeier*

*Opening Reception August 29, 2025*
*1719 S. Clinton St, Chicago*
*17:00-20:00*

"In digital late modernity, we conceal the nakedness—the absence of meaning in our lives—by constantly posting, liking, and sharing. The noise of communication and information is supposed to ensure that life's terrifying vacuity remains hidden."

- Byung-Chul Han

No Wifi is pleased to present *Unthinking: Somewhere and Elsewhere*, a solo exhibition by Reid Surmeier, opening Friday, August 29, 2025. The works find the artist continuing his exploration of the tensions of digital modernity, its paradoxical role in both enabling and obstructing human fulfillment and purpose within contemporary life. Taking inspiration from assemblages and early digital paintings, and borrowing from the aesthetics of Impressionism and Fauvist tradition, the work offers a perceptual hybridity between digital and physical art worlds. They feature images of interconnected forms such as trees and pixelated masses; surreal representations of simplified landscapes; absorbing the viewer in a familiar yet not-quite-mixed reality.

These painterly digital hybrids mirror our contemporary cognitive landscape. In an era defined by the relentless onslaught of short form content and passively consumed images, delivered through ever optimizing algorithms, our daily intake of media has expanded exponentially. Much of what is consumed remains relevant only fleetingly, leaving behind an accumulation of random, disorganized information devoid of substance or worth.

The artist argues that through this mediated existence in a state of distraction, individuals' inner worlds transform into mere reflections, a jumbled mess of news headlines, Instagram posts, targeted advertisements, normative influences, and global conflict.

The series of five paintings on view visualize the distressed and cluttered thoughts, digital images, and experiences crammed into the mind, a consequence of relentless overconsumption, rendered through layered glazes and competing perspectives where overgrown landscapes press against fractured figural elements. Along with the series of paintings, the artist uses a set of brightly chromatic commercial LED light panels to disrupt his own exhibition, creating an immersive, almost destabilizing experience. LED panels act as a visceral counterpoint to the paintings, forcing a choice between contemplation and surrender to the exhibition's engineered distractions. Like the digital distraction they echo, these lights replicate the modern condition, the displacement of contemplation by the compulsion to glance away

**Reid Surmeier**
(b. Chicago, 2005) is an American multidisciplinary artist working across computation, painting, and sculpture. His work explores the evolving relationship between humans and computers, focusing on how both are increasingly intertwined in the processes of creating, perceiving, and interpreting reality. Recent exhibitions include From What is Design Autonomous? and the EFS Show at Waterman Gallery, Providence, RI (2025), After Dinner Coffee at Memorial Hall, Providence (2025), Reframing Representation at the Center for Integrative Technologies (CIT), (2024), and Technical Touch at 111 Franklin Street, NYC (2024).